

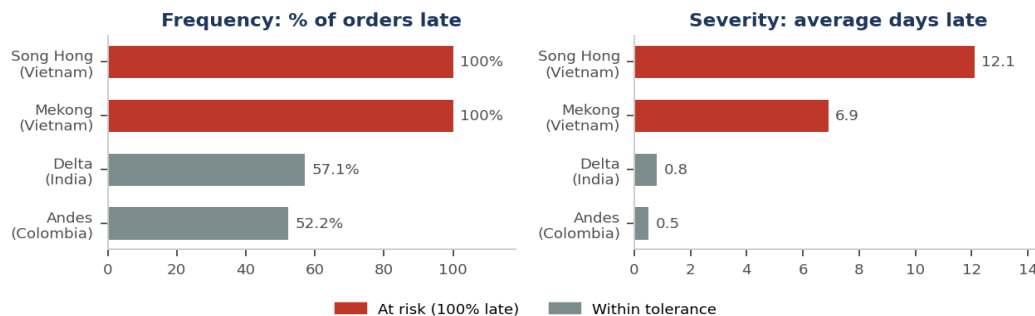
DENVER LAUNCH READINESS

A milestone-gated supplier decision | GreenThreads Operations | Analysis date: August 12, 2026 | Opening: October 12, 2026
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DECISION REQUEST: Approve exception control for Active Shorts and Bamboo Joggers now; release expedite or backup-source spend only after a verified milestone slip or failed two-week buffer test.

01 SIGNAL

Both Vietnam suppliers were late on every completed order. Across 80 received purchase orders, Song Hong and Mekong were late on 100% of shipments, averaging 12.1 and 6.9 days, respectively, while Andes and Delta averaged 0.5 and 0.8 days, respectively. Frequency and severity are both reported because they answer different questions: Mekong matches Song Hong's late rate on a larger base and has 9 of 9 in-transit orders already past promise. At the same time, Song Hong is the more severe delay. No shipment in the file has ever arrived early, so an on-time rate alone would flatter every supplier.



02 EXPOSURE

Half of Denver's launch retail value is tied to those two suppliers.

Launch product	Supplier	Units	Retail value	Avg late	Control implication
EcoFleece Hoodie	Andes Knitworks	850	\$83,300	0.5 d	Monitor deadline; verify carton quantity.
Classic Tee	Delta Organics	1,600	\$60,800	0.8 d	Monitor deadline; verify carton quantity.
Active Shorts	Mekong Textile Co.	1,200	\$69,600	6.9 d	Exception control: milestones, buffer test, contingency quote.
Bamboo Joggers	Song Hong Apparel	950	\$74,100	12.1 d	Exception control: milestones, buffer test, contingency quote.
EXPOSED	2 Vietnam suppliers	2,150	\$143,700	49.9%	of \$287,800 total launch retail value

Planning inference, not a forecast: applying Song Hong's 12.1-day mean to SH-2291's October 3 promise implies roughly an October 15 receipt, three days after opening. Operations must confirm the required in-store date and obtain dated milestones before spending or changing the order.

03 DECISION

Choice	Operating move	Trade-off/limitation	Position
A. Observe	Rely on promised dates and routine monitoring.	No control at all for two suppliers with 100% late histories.	Reject
B. Control	Require ex-factory, container-load, booking, and weekly milestones on both Vietnam launch POs; test the SOP two-week buffer.	Earlier visibility at no freight cost, but monitoring alone creates no backup if a milestone slips.	Partial
C. Gate	Adopt B, secure partial-expedite and backup-source quotes now, release spend only on a verified trigger, and set a standing rule that any supplier averaging over 3 days late gets an automatic two-week buffer.	Preserves action time and prevents recurrence; requires cross-functional coordination, and the final cost remains quote-based.	APPROVE

Recommendation: Approve Choice C. It targets the two suppliers with verified 100% late rates, avoids paying to rush units that would sell weeks after opening, and turns a one-time save into a standing rule tied to the Functional Brief goal of an on-time Denver opening.

Tools, Method & Verification. Shipment and catalog files analyzed in ChatGPT Work (reasoning tier) and Claude (Opus / Sonnet 4.6), independently recomputed in Python/pandas, and reproduced as live formulas in the linked workbook, so no figure rests on a number a model typed. Cleaning found 0 duplicate POs, 0 required-field gaps, 0 date/status conflicts, 0 line-cost errors, 0 catalog-mapping errors, and 0 Days_Late mismatches across 80 received rows; 16 in-transit blanks were preserved as valid unknowns and measured against the analysis date rather than zeroed; 3 launch buys were flagged as partial cartons for confirmation rather than silently changed. Supplier-name normalization is retained in the pipeline after an earlier export split one supplier across two spellings. Spot checks: PO-4400 = 400 x \$26 = \$10,400 and 8 days late; PO-4401 = 0 days late; PO-4402 blanks valid in transit. **Decision rights:** Operations owns escalation; Procurement owns spend and sourcing; Legal owns contract terms; AI calculates and flags, but a human reviews every trigger and makes the final call—supporting analysis: linked Google Sheets workbook.